

Tobby Smith

Engineering Leader | Digital Transformation & Scaling High-Performing Teams

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AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Engineering Leadership: Team building, hiring, performance management, cross-functional collaboration

Digital Transformation: Legacy modernization, Next.js migration, frontend architecture at scale

Strategic Planning: Roadmapping, organizational design, executive communication, ROI modeling

Performance & Delivery: Core Web Vitals, continuous delivery, CI/CD, developer experience, Agile/Scrum

Technical Expertise: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Angular, HTML/CSS, REST APIs, AWS

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 8+ years building and scaling engineering teams and 15+ years delivering high-performance web applications at scale. Currently leading the multi-year modernization of Zappos.com's frontend to Next.js, delivering a 40% LCP improvement, a shift from weekly releases to continuous delivery, and features such as Apple Pay that generated \$90M in ordered product sales. Drove executive adoption of a front-end centralization strategy that lifted delivery velocity 30%. Skilled at scaling teams and translating engineering investment into measurable business outcomes.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Manager III

July 2022 - Present

Zappos (Amazon) | Las Vegas, NV

Promoted from Software Engineering Manager II (July 2022 - May 2024)

- Grew and led the front-end engineering team for Zappos.com and 6pm.com from 4 to 8 engineers, owning core e-commerce experiences for millions of customers
- Led a multi-year migration of Zappos.com's legacy frontend to a modern Next.js architecture, achieving a 40% improvement in Largest Contentful Paint (LCP) and reducing technical debt across marketplaces
- Re-architected the deployment pipeline from weekly releases to continuous delivery, cutting deploy times from several days to under an hour and reducing new-engineer onboarding from two months to under one week
- Delivered high-impact customer features including Apple Pay, driving \$90M in ordered product sales
- Authored and drove executive adoption of a proposal to centralize Zappos front-end engineering, increasing delivery velocity 30% and standardizing engineering best practices across teams

Software Engineering Manager

January 2018 - July 2022

Koddi | Ann Arbor, MI

- Led a team of 5 front-end engineers owning the web applications for Koddi Ads and Koddi Demand, enterprise commerce media platforms powering retail media networks and franchise advertising for global travel and retail brands
- Delivered complex campaign management, bidding, and analytics interfaces integrated with major partners including Google Hotel Ads, TripAdvisor, Kayak, and Trivago, architecting large-scale Angular and React applications
- Built and mentored the team, establishing coding standards, sprint planning, and roadmapping that improved delivery predictability and code quality across products

Sr. Software Engineer / UX Tech Lead

October 2014 - January 2018

Criteo / HookLogic (Acquired by Criteo, 2016) | Ann Arbor, MI

- Led the UX engineering team at HookLogic, a retail media advertising platform, owning a full re-platform of the customer-facing frontend to Angular and WebAPI and establishing the team's engineering standards
- Retained through Criteo's acquisition of HookLogic, advancing to Sr. Software Engineer on a global digital advertising platform processing hundreds of billions of dollars in sales data

Earlier Career

Centurion Medical Products | Jackson National Life | IBM | Meijer | Smith Design Services

Progressive front-end engineering roles spanning enterprise web applications, mobile development, UI architecture, and digital marketing - building a deep technical foundation across industries

EDUCATION

Davenport University, 2004 - 2006